



STEP 05 Next comes the motherboard. The cardboard in our box is sturdy enough to support our mini-ITX motherboard along with a graphics card attached to it. We aren't sure whether it will be able to support a full ATX motherboard. Hence, we attached another layer of corrugated cardboard to make it sturdier. To hold the motherboard, we used zip ties. This time we inserted two zip ties in the motherboard holes and created a loop between the two. They were tightened to the point where the zip ends held the motherboard firmly.



STEP 06 Storage drives can be attached the same way we installed the PSU. If you're using a hard drive, we would recommend you to place it at the bottom because of the weight. We added some padding below the SSD to give it some elevation so that it was easier to attach the cables.



STEP 07 With all the components installed, we are left with the exhaust fan. You have complete freedom to install it either on the top or on the rear. We decided to install a 120mm fan on the top. This wouldn't have been possible if we hadn't left enough room between the motherboard and the top side. According to the fan's diameter, a circle was cut out. The four corners of the fan were secured with zip ties similar to what we did with the motherboard.



STEP 08 You might not always find a power button on the motherboard. You can either jump the power button with a screwdriver every time or just attach a power button. They can be bought for under ₹10. Stick them on the box wherever you wish and connect it to the power button headers on the motherboard.



STEP 09 Cable management is optional but it's better to avoid cables dangling inside the box. You definitely don't want the mess to be visible if you're installing the acrylic sheet. The remaining zip ties can be used to bundle the cables together.



STEP 10 Your very own cardboard box PC is now ready. As you must have realised, you can improve the design a lot. More fans can be installed on the front for air intake and support for radiators can be added too. Just make sure that you add padding whenever you're installing a heavy component, and fortify your cardboard frame with more cardboard!